

Hepatitis B Surface Antibody, Qualitative

Test Details

METHODOLOGY

Immunochemiluminometric assay (ICMA)

RESULT TURNAROUND TIME

1 - 2 days

Turnaround time is defined as the usual number of days from the date of pickup of a specimen for testing to when the result is released to the ordering provider. In some cases, additional time should be allowed for additional confirmatory or additional reflex tests. Testing schedules may vary.

Use

Presence of antibody to hepatitis B surface antigen (anti-HBs) is used to determine immune status to HBV or disease progression in individuals infected with HBV. Anti-HBs levels can be measured to determine if vaccination is needed, or following a vaccination regimen, to determine if protective immunity has been achieved.

Limitations

Presence of anti-HBs is not an absolute indicator of resolved hepatitis infection, nor of protection from future infection. Since there are different serologic subtypes of hepatitis B virus, it is possible (and has been reported) for a patient to have antibody to one surface antigen type and to be acutely infected with virus of a different subtype. Thus, a patient may have coexisting HBsAg and anti-HBs. Transfused individuals or hemophiliacs receiving plasma components may give false-positive tests for antibody to hepatitis B surface antigen.

Custom Additional Information

Anti-HBs usually can be detected several weeks to several months after HBsAg is no longer found, and it may persist for many years or for life after acute infection has been resolved. It may disappear in some patients, with only antibody to core remaining. Patients with this antibody are not overtly infectious. Presence of the antibody without the presence of the antigen is evidence for immunity from reinfection, with virus of the same subtype.

Specimen Requirements

Specimen

Serum **or** plasma

Volume

0.5 mL

Minimum Volume

0.3 mL (**Note:** This volume does **not** allow for repeat testing.)

Container

Red-top tube, gel-barrier tube, **or** lavender-top (EDTA) tube

Collection Instructions

If tube other than a gel-barrier tube is used, transfer separated serum or plasma to a plastic transport tube.

Stability Requirements

Temperature	Period
Room temperature	14 days
Refrigerated	14 days
Frozen	14 days
Freeze/thaw cycles	Stable x3

Reference Range

- **Nonreactive:** not immune to HBV infection
- **Equivocal:** unable to determine if anti-HBs is present at levels consistent with immunity
- **Reactive:** anti-HBs concentration detected at greater than 10 mIU/mL; individual is considered to be immune to infection with HBV

Storage Instructions

Room temperature

Causes for Rejection

Cadaver specimens; heat-inactivated specimens; body fluids other than serum or plasma

References

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